

do not allow users to login as “root” as a safety precaution, but people who want complete control over their device can figure a way out.

DingleBerry

Oddly named “DingleBerry” this tool lets users gain root access into their PlayBooks. This process is also called “jailbreaking” at times.

While this might sound like a trivial task to ordinary users, the techniques to gain root access into mobile devices is quite complicated, mainly

due to the security measures put in place by manufacturers.

DingleBerry has been around since late 2011, and has since then undergone 3 major updates, with a fourth one due very soon. As of now the tool doesn’t support the latest version of PlayBook OS, which is what the fourth major release would probably address.

The tool makes the rooting process really simple, requiring just a few clicks from the user’s end to gain unfettered root access to a PlayBook.

After the tool completes exploiting vulnerabilities in the PlayBook OS in order to gain root access, it opens up an SSH port on the PlayBook and enables remote “root” login.

Gaining root access opens up a wide array of possibilities, like adding support for USB devices, adding support for services that were blocked on the PlayBook, customizing the interface and a lot more.

Adding support for USB thumb drives is particularly handy, due to the ease of transfer, and, of course, the extra storage. (only works in the US though).

Since rooting exposes the entire filesystem, adventurous users also got hold of the locations used by the system to fetch icons and other resources such as fonts, and managed to alter the resources and implement a crude way of theming the PlayBook OS.

Of course if rooting doesn’t bring any big changes for the end user, it’s not useful enough. So how about installing the whole Android Market (now called Google Play) onto the device?

